



YOU ARE **33 WEEKS EXACTLY**
49 days to go

YOUR BABY TODAY

Soon your baby's lungs will be able to fully support them after birth. At 33 weeks, though, most babies would still need some help with breathing if born this early. Your baby will be regularly practicing breathing movements inside.

“Choosing who will be present at the birth with you is a big decision, so start thinking about it in good time.”

You can choose whoever you like to be your support partner at the hospital. During public health emergencies, your hospital may limit the number of support persons allowed. If you are allowed more than one person, you may consider whether you'd like to ask your mom, sister, or close friend to be present at delivery, or hire a doula. It's also good to have a backup plan in case your partner is unable to make it, whether planned or due to unexpected circumstances.

There may be many other people in your life who would like to be present with you and are unable—you can stay connected and share these special memories with them by taking pictures or even video calls. Not all hospitals allow you to record the birth, so be sure to ask in advance before you start filming.

ACTIVE BIRTH CLASSES

The goal of active birth classes is to make women feel good about their bodies and give them the confidence that they have the mental and physical reserves to have a successful birth experience. Classes are generally appropriate regardless of fitness level, flexibility, and your stage of pregnancy.

- **Active birth classes** promote the benefits of yoga and exercise as both physical and mental preparation for childbirth.
- **Yoga strengthens the body**, improves posture and circulation, and teaches how to use relaxation and breathing techniques to relieve stress.
- **Like prenatal classes**, active birth classes allow you to meet other parents-to-be and share their pregnancy experiences.
- **The downside** is that these classes aren't widely available, so they get booked quickly and can be expensive. Ask your doctor about local classes. If you can't find a class in your area, read an active birth book or consider taking a prenatal yoga class.